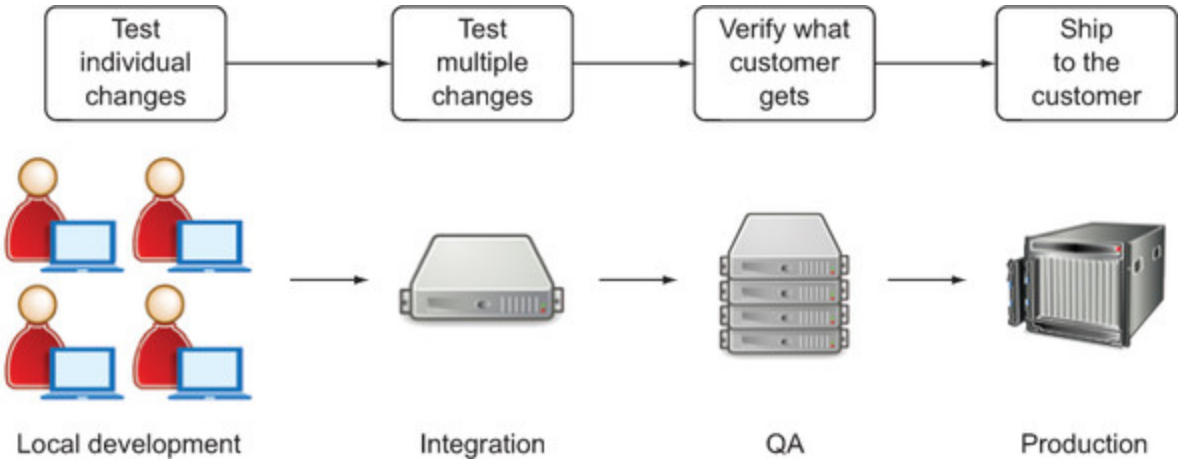


Because teams typically have multiple environments in the path to production, to make system monitoring data as proactive as possible you should be able to access it as close to the development environment as possible, ideally in the integration and/or QA stages.

A second way to mitigate this problem is to release new code to only a small number of your consumers and monitor how their activity affects the system. This is usually referred to as a *canary deploy* and is becoming more common in agile teams practicing CD.

Depending on your deployment platform, different tools are available for system monitoring. New Relic, AppDynamics, and Dynatrace are all popular tools in this space. We will go into much more detail about these in chapter 6.

All of the data we've looked at so far can tell you a lot about your team and how effectively you're working together. But before you can make this data useful, you need to figure out what is good and what is bad, especially in an agile world where your core metrics are relative.

Here are questions you can answer from your production-monitoring systems:

- How well is your code functioning?
- How well are you serving the consumer?